

Emotional Dynamics and Consensus Quality in Hebrew-Wikipedia Mental-Health Talk Pages

Working report (Wikimedia Israel / Dror Lin fund)

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1 Research question

Do emotional expressions in talk-page discussions (aggression, conciliation, exhaustion, contagion) predict the structure of the discussion (dropout vs. convergence) and, through it, the quality of the resulting article version—measured as *stability* (survival of a consensus version without reverts) and *correctness* (expert accuracy ratings)? Do stability and correctness agree?

2 Corpus

2.1 Scope

Hebrew Wikipedia only. Two rings: a clinical core (disorders, psychiatry, clinical psychology, addiction, stress-related, eating disorders) and an adjacent ring of high-activity psychology-in-public-discourse articles (e.g. suicide, gaslighting, gender dysphoria, pedophilia). Curated manually for seriousness and activity; article list to be finalized jointly.

2.2 Scoping (Sept 2026)

Category crawl of the clinical core: 422 articles, 330 with talk pages; 193 with ≥ 2 KB of discussion, 88 with ≥ 5 KB, 45 with ≥ 10 KB, 23 with ≥ 20 KB. Archive subpages not yet counted.

Pipeline v0 on 12 seed articles (talk pages plus archives):

Takeaway: the clinical core is real but thin; the thread, not the article, is the natural unit of analysis, and a corpus of roughly 60–100 curated articles is needed for adequate coverage.

3 Pipeline

1. Fetch: talk page + archive subpages (current text) and full revision metadata of talk and article (MediaWiki API).
2. Thread segmentation by section headings; comment extraction by signature timestamps; editor identification from user links.
3. Emotion layer: operationalization (lexicon-based vs. LLM coding) is an open decision.
4. Dynamics layer: participation trajectories, dropout, convergence, interaction network per thread.

Article	Threads	Signed comments	Threads ≥ 5	Threads ≥ 10
Autism	69	353	20	12
Schizophrenia	47	137	10	2
Psychopathy	32	98	5	3
Clinical depression	27	86	2	2
Mental disorder	28	66	2	1
Borderline PD	27	65	3	1
OCD	19	64	2	1
Psychotherapy	17	63	6	2
PTSD	21	45	1	0
Bipolar disorder	22	39	1	1
Anorexia nervosa	17	21	0	0
Anxiety disorder	7	18	1	1
Total	333	1055	53	26

Table 1: Seed-set talk-page activity. Comments counted by signature timestamps.

5. Outcome layer: stability from article revision/revert history; correctness via expert rating protocol.

4 Measures

To be defined.

5 Results

6 Discussion